

Category: International Shipping & Tax Compliance

Document ID: doc_07_customs_duties

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Revision: 2.9

VoltVibe International Customs, Import Duties, and Cross-Border Taxation Policy

1. Importer of Record and International Liability

For all orders shipped outside the United States, the recipient is legally designated as the Importer of Record. As the Importer of Record, the customer must comply with all local laws and regulations of the destination country, and is solely responsible for all import taxes, customs duties, value-added taxes (VAT), brokerage fees, and quarantine inspection charges. VoltVibe does not calculate or collect international taxes at checkout. Standard product prices and carrier shipping rates (as detailed in doc_08) represent net shipping costs and do not include import levies.

2. International Shipping Terms (DDU / DAP)

All international shipments are dispatched under Delivery Duty Unpaid (DDU) terms, also known as Delivered at Place (DAP). Under these terms, VoltVibe's shipping carriers (primarily DHL Express and FedEx International) will contact the customer directly once the package arrives at the local border hub. The carrier will provide an itemized invoice detailing the customs clearance fees and local import duties. The carrier will also charge a standardized administrative brokerage fee (typically ranging from \$15.00 to \$25.00 USD, or a fixed percentage of duties paid, whichever is higher) to cover their border filing expenses. VoltVibe has no control over these brokerage rates and cannot request waivers on behalf of the importer.

3. Border Delay Procedures and Documentation

Customs clearances can cause unpredictable transit delays that are outside the carrier's standard delivery guarantees.

3.1 Carrier Hold Windows & Refusal Abandonment

Packages delayed at local customs checkpoints are typically held for a maximum of 14 calendar days. The carrier will make three attempts to contact the importer using the phone number and email address provided at checkout. If the customer refuses to pay the assessed import fees, or fails to respond within the 14-day hold window, the shipment is classified as refused. If a package is refused, the carrier will charge VoltVibe return shipping freight costs. **REFUSAL PENALTY:** VoltVibe will deduct the carrier's return shipping costs, import duties, and brokerage fees from the customer's final product refund. If the return shipping costs exceed the value of the order, the package is declared abandoned at customs, resulting in a complete loss of the shipment. In this scenario, the customer receives zero refund or store credit.

3.2 Customs Documentation Requests

Customs authorities frequently request verification of the purchase price or a commercial invoice to ensure tax compliance. Customers can download a copy of their commercial invoice directly from their VoltVibe customer profile under the Order History tab. Under no circumstances will VoltVibe modify the values listed on a commercial invoice or declare packages as 'gifts' to avoid import taxes, as doing so violates federal export laws and international customs compliance protocols.

4. HAZMAT Shipping and Regulatory Audits

The shipment of high-capacity lithium-ion battery modules introduces significant customs compliance challenges. Products containing battery modules exceeding 100 Watt-hours (Wh) (specifically including the VoltVibe Titan PowerStation and expansion battery blocks) are categorized as Class 9 Dangerous Goods under international maritime and aviation laws.

4.1 Mandatory Dangerous Goods Declarations (DGD)

CRITICAL BATTERY COMPLIANCE RULE: Due to the safety risks of transporting high-capacity energy storage units, importing these items into the European Union, Australia, or the United Kingdom requires a signed Dangerous Goods Declaration (DGD) from the importer. Once the shipment reaches the destination border, the carrier will notify the customer and request the DGD. The customer must sign and submit this declaration within 72 hours of border arrival. Failure to submit this document within 72 hours will result in immediate seizure and destruction of the package by customs officials. VoltVibe is legally prohibited from refunding orders destroyed due to customer failure to submit dangerous goods declarations.

4.2 International Battery Customs Audits

Certain countries, particularly Australia and Germany, conduct physical compliance audits on Class 9 Dangerous Goods. These audits can delay packages by 5 to 10 additional business days at the port of entry. VoltVibe is not liable for transit timeline failures resulting from regulatory battery audits, and shipping charges will not be refunded for shipments affected by HAZMAT-related custom delays.